

SPIDER-MAN

Peter sided with IRON MAN (Tony Stark) during the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), even going so far as to register with the government and expose his true identity during a televised press conference. He quickly came to regret the decision when he saw the tactics the pro-registration forces were used to win, and he switched sides to join CAPTAIN AMERICA's resistance. For a short time, he returned to his black costume while he, Mary Jane, and Aunt May went into hiding, but he soon returned to his red and blue suit.

AUNT MAY SHOT

Besides the government hounding him, Peter now had to deal with the fact that all his old foes knew who he was. From inside prison, the KINGPIN hired an assassin, who waited outside the hotel room in which Peter, Mary Jane, and Aunt May were staying. When Peter's guard was down, he fired. Peter's spider-sense enabled him to dodge the bullet, but it struck Aunt May. Peter and Mary Jane rushed her to the hospital, where the doctor informed them that she was too frail to survive.



Peter heeded his spider-sense and dodged the bullet. It hit Aunt May instead.

Tony refused, saying that he couldn't be seen aiding and abetting a known criminal like Peter. Breaking free from the webs, he flew off without trying to arrest Peter again, but he made it clear that he could not help. Later, Tony's butler, Edwin Jarvis—who had been dating Aunt May—arrived at the hospital with a check for two million dollars to help pay for her care. Despite the money, however, the doctor believed that Aunt May would not live long.

MEPHISTO'S DEAL

Torn apart with guilt over Aunt May's shooting, Peter scoured the city for a cure. He visited DR. STRANGE, who transported Spider-Man's astral form around the globe to ask for help, but no one could do anything to save her. He even tried to travel back in time to stop the shooter, but failed.

Then MEPHISTO approached Peter and Mary Jane with an offer. He would save Aunt May and alter reality so that no one would remember that Peter was Spider-Man. All he wanted in exchange was their greatest source of happiness: their marriage.

Searching their souls, Peter and Mary Jane agreed to Mephisto's offer. The next morning, Peter awoke alone—but with Aunt May alive and well and cooking him a stack of wheatcakes—and with no one aware that anything had ever been different.

ALL CHANGE

While Mephisto had supposedly only made a couple of changes, their effect was to alter Peter's life drastically. He was alone once again, living at his Aunt May's and looking for an apartment in Manhattan. His old friend HARRY OSBORN had returned after being presumed dead. And without Mary Jane in his life, Peter was unlucky in love.

An anguished Peter and Mary Jane waited by Aunt May's hospital bed, realizing that only a miracle could save her. It would come from a most unexpected source.



Tired of bargaining for souls, Mephisto demanded something far more rare from Peter and Mary Jane: the pure happiness found in their true love for each other.

Some things, however, stayed the same. With the *Daily Bugle* having cash troubles, J. Jonah JAMESON hadn't paid Peter for several photos he'd bought. When Peter confronted Jameson about the money he was owed, they fell into a shouting match, and Jameson collapsed from a heart attack. Jameson survived, but the paper had to be sold, and Peter wound up working as a paparazzi. He soon gave that up to become a photographer for Ben Urich's new paper, *Front Line*.

ALTERED STATES

Many of Spider-Man's foes cropped up soon after Peter's life changed. With his secret identity once more intact, however, he could fight them on his own terms.

Aunt May now did volunteer work at a homeless shelter, working under the philanthropist Martin Li, who was secretly Chinatown crimelord Mr. Negative. Eddie Brock returned, no longer as VENOM but as the new ANTI-VENOM. Norman Osborn showed up as the leader of the THUNDERBOLTS and even, eventually, the AVENGERS—a separate team from the secret Avengers with which Spider-Man still worked. He also battled a new villain called Menace, who used many of the Green Goblin's old tricks.

A new hero—Jackpot—entered Peter's life too. As she was a tall, beautiful redhead, Peter suspected her of actually being Mary Jane, with whom he still had a romantic—but apparently sour—history. Instead, she turned out to be Alana Jobson, a woman who'd bought the identity from Sara Ehret. Alana died soon after Peter learned her secret, destroyed by the drugs she'd been taking to gain her powers.

While Peter enjoyed the fact that no one but he knew his secret identity, he recently told a few of his friends on his Avengers team his true name. **MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• **Civil War #1-7** During the Civil War, Spider-Man registers with the government and reveals his identity to the world—and then comes to regret it.

• **One More Day, tpb** With Aunt May at death's door after taking a sniper's bullet meant for Peter, he and Mary Jane cut a deal with Mephisto to trade their marriage to save her life.

• **Amazing Spider-Man #546** His marriage erased—along with any knowledge anyone has about his secret identity—Spider-Man starts again fresh, but alone.



Peter saved Jameson's life by giving him CPR after he collapsed during an argument. Later, as Spider-Man, he had to do so again when he inadvertently told Jameson that his wife had sold the *Bugle* while he was ill.



Menace turned out to be none other than Lily Hollister, the woman who Peter's unwitting friend Harry Osborn (the second Green Goblin) hoped to marry. As Menace, she publicly attacked her father to drum up sympathy support for his mayoral campaign.



Both Peter Parker and Spider-Man started all over again with a *Brand New Day*—but Mary Jane was no longer by Peter's side.

Needing money to pay for Aunt May's treatment, Peter turned to the wealthiest man he knew: Tony Stark. Tony immediately changed into Iron Man and tried to arrest Peter, but Peter managed to web Iron Man up with his new webs, which now sprang directly from his wrists rather than from a webshooter. While Iron Man was trapped, Peter accused Tony of misleading him into making the worst mistake of his life. Then he demanded that Tony help Aunt May.



Peter Parker tangled up Iron Man in his webs, forcing Tony Stark to listen to his pleas for financial help to save Aunt May's life.



I TRUSTED YOU! I LET YOU GET CLOSE TO ME... YOU WERE LIKE A FATHER TO ME!

I TRUSTED YOU WHEN YOU SAID I WENT TO A PARTY OF IDIOTS THAT IT WAS THE ONLY WAY I COULD GET TO THE PERFECT MAN... ALL BUT YOU! YOU WERE THE ONLY ONE WHO WASN'T!